

Your Countdown to Papers 2 & 3

A day-by-day revision plan from now to both calculator papers — Paper 2 on Wed 3 June and Paper 3 on Wed 10 June 2026. Built around the topics most worth your time on the calculator papers.

How to use this plan. Each day has *one main focus* plus a short active-recall task — because cramming everything at once doesn't work, but a focused topic a day does. Do the focus topic, then attempt a few real past-paper questions on it (calculator allowed). Tick each day off. The plan front-loads the highest-value calculator topics from the companion **Topic Focus** sheet, builds in full past-paper practice, and leaves the final day before each exam for light review and rest — not new content.

Adapt it to you. If you're already strong on a topic, swap that day for one of your weak areas. This is a structure, not a straitjacket.

1 Phase 1 — Run-up to Paper 2 (Wed 3 June)

Sun 24 May · Today

SET UP

Plan & calculator setup. Read the Topic Focus sheet. Set up your calculator (Degrees mode, clear memory) using the Calculator Skills guide. Identify your 3 weakest topics and note them.

Mon 25 May · Mon

NUMBER

Standard form + factors/multiples/HCF/LCM. These ran light on Paper 1 and are calculator-friendly. Practise standard-form arithmetic on your calculator using the $\times 10^x$ key.

Tue 26 May · Tue

NUMBER

Percentages & reverse percentages + compound interest/growth & decay. High-frequency calculator topics. Drill the multiplier method and the $(1 \pm r/100)^n$ formula.

Wed 27 May · Wed

RATIO

Ratio, proportion & compound measures. Speed/distance/time, density, pressure, best-buy. Set up the formula triangles and watch your units.

Thu 28 May · Thu

GEOMETRY

Trigonometry: SOH-CAH-TOA + sine & cosine rules. Calculator papers love these. Practise finding both sides and angles; check Degrees mode every time.

Fri 29 May · Fri

GEOMETRY

Area, volume & surface area + Pythagoras. Include cylinders, cones, spheres (Higher). Learn which formulae are given vs which you must memorise.

Sat 30 May · Sat

FULL PAPER

Sit a full past Paper 2 under timed conditions (90 min, calculator). Mark it harshly against the mark scheme. List every topic you lost marks on.

Sun 31 May · Sun

FIX GAPS

Fix the gaps from yesterday's paper. Go back to the exact topics you lost marks on and redo similar questions until they're secure.

Mon 1 Jun · Mon

STATS/ALG

Statistics + algebra essentials. Mean from frequency tables (use STAT mode), cumulative frequency, box plots; plus solving equations and rearranging formulae.

Tue 2 Jun · Tue

LIGHT REVIEW

Light review only — do NOT learn new topics. Re-read your formula sheets, skim your error list, do a few quick questions. Pack your bag, calculator, spare batteries. Sleep early.

Wed 3 Jun · Wed

PAPER 2

PAPER 2 (Calculator) — morning. Degrees mode on. Carry exact values with ANS. Show every line of working. Don't round until the end. You've got this.

2 Phase 2 — Run-up to Paper 3 (Wed 10 June)

Thu 4 Jun · Thu

RESET

Quick reflection (don't dwell). Note which topics felt shaky in Paper 2 — those are your priorities for Paper 3, since Paper 3 covers the same specification. Rest a little; the hardest part is done.

Fri 5 Jun · Fri

WEAK TOPICS

Target your Paper 2 weak spots. Whatever caught you out on Paper 2, drill it now with topic-specific past-paper questions.

Sat 6 Jun · Sat

FULL PAPER

Sit a full past Paper 3 under timed conditions. Mark harshly. By now you should see your timing and accuracy improving.

Sun 7 Jun · Sun

HIGHER TOPICS

Higher-grade / high-value topics. Vectors (proof & collinearity), circle theorems (learn the reasons), 3D Pythagoras & trig, quadratic inequalities. Foundation: probability trees, ratio problems, advanced percentages.

Mon 8 Jun · Mon

FIX GAPS

Fix gaps + a second timed paper if you have one. Focus relentlessly on the topics where you keep dropping marks rather than re-doing what you can already do.

Tue 9 Jun · Tue

LIGHT REVIEW

Light review only. Re-read formula sheets, skim your full error list from both papers, a handful of quick questions. Calculator checked, bag packed, early night.

Wed 10 Jun · Wed

PAPER 3

PAPER 3 (Calculator) — morning. Same exam-day habits: Degrees mode, exact values via ANS, full working, round only at the end. Last one — finish strong.

The three rules that matter most: (1) **Practise full past papers** — nothing else builds exam stamina and timing like sitting real papers under timed conditions. (2) **Revise your mistakes, not your strengths** — every hour spent on a topic you've already mastered is an hour wasted. (3) **The day before each exam is for review and rest, never new content** — a calm, rested brain scores higher than an exhausted, crammed one.